Part I: Party identity and philosophy

The meritocratic thesis

"Those who create value should own the assets their contributions produce. This is not redistribution – it is recognition. It is not charity – it is justice. It is not left or right – it is forward."

The Meritocratic Party starts from a simple claim: the people who create value should own a real, tradeable stake in that value.

In the 20th century, we built infrastructure to own physical things—deeds for land, titles for cars, stock certificates for corporate shares. In the 21st century, the economy runs on **intangible assets** (ideas, data, expertise, IP), which now make up roughly 92% of S&P 500 market capitalization, yet we have no equivalent ownership infrastructure for the people who create that value.

Provenance-Backed Securities (PBS) are the proposed ownership infrastructure for this intangible economy: a way to document who contributed, measure how well those contributions perform, and trade ownership on regulated exchanges.

Why a new party

Neither major party—and no existing third party—squarely answers this question:

"Do the people who create intangible value have the right to own what they create?"

- **Democrats:** Focus on redistribution (UBI, safety nets, progressive taxation) after value has already been captured.
- **Republicans:** Emphasize deregulation and markets, but markets can't function for assets that have no instruments, standards, or exchanges.
- **Libertarians:** Center individual ownership, but lack a concrete blueprint for building ownership infrastructure for intangible assets.

The Meritocratic Party is about **infrastructure, not ideology**: building the legal, technical, and market plumbing so that creators can actually own and trade what they produce.

The five pillars

Pillar 1: Contribution earns ownership If you create the value, you own the asset. Provenance documents who contributed. Performance measures how much. Exchange ensures fair compensation.

Pillar 2: Empiricism over ideology Policy should be driven by measurable outcomes. Performance oracles measure what works; they don't care about party labels.

Pillar 3: Infrastructure, not redistribution We don't start by taking from some to give to others. We build exchanges, legal frameworks, and standards so everyone can participate in ownership—like the Amsterdam Stock Exchange did for industrial-era capital.

Pillar 4: Technology serves people AI and automation should create ownership opportunities for the workers whose expertise they consume, not just profits for the corporations that deploy them. AI training royalties are pro-creator, not anti-tech.

Pillar 5: Transparency is non-negotiable Provenance is public. Performance is measured. Ownership is verifiable. In a meritocracy, everyone can see who created what, how well it performs, and who benefits.

Symbol and brand (high-level only)

- **Symbol:** The Seedling – growth from contribution, rooted in merit, reaching toward value.
- **Core metaphor:**
    - **Soil:** Legal framework (PBS laws and standards)
    - **Water:** Exchange protocol (liquidity and markets)
    - **Sunlight:** Performance measurement (oracles and evidence)
    - **Seedling:** The creator's contribution

Color palette and visual identity can be summarized publicly (navy, gold, white, green) without exposing internal design specs or file systems.

Part II: The meritocratic platform – 12 planks

Below are public-facing summaries of each plank, suitable for a website.

Plank 1: Provenance-Backed Securities Act

Principle: The intangible economy needs ownership infrastructure as robust as what exists for physical assets.

Support state and federal legislation that creates a regulated framework for tokenizing intangible assets with verified provenance and measured performance. PBS are designed as **securities**, not unregulated crypto tokens, and operate within existing securities law.

Plank 2: Worker expertise ownership

Principle: Your skills, your knowledge, your asset.

Workers hold an enforceable ownership interest in their **provenance-documented expertise**—their specialized knowledge, techniques, and professional judgment. Employers should not be able to force workers to waive that ownership as a condition of employment.

Plank 3: AI training royalties

Principle: When your expertise trains an AI system, you retain an ownership interest.

When human work—code, writing, designs, processes, data—is used to train or fine-tune AI systems, the contributors should receive ongoing royalties or equity-like participation tied to that system's economic value.

Plank 4: The SeedBid initiative (agricultural IP)

Principle: Farmers deserve choice; breeders deserve fair value.

Create a PBS exchange for **seed genetics and agricultural IP**, allowing independent breeders to sell fractional ownership in their varieties. This introduces transparent price discovery and competition into a market currently dominated by a small number of global seed firms.

Plank 5: Creative ownership infrastructure

Principle: Creators deserve performance-verified securities, not just copyright.

Musicians, artists, game developers, and writers should be able to issue PBS backed by **real performance data**—streaming revenue, sales, engagement—rather than relying solely on copyright and opaque platform payouts.

Plank 6: Data sovereignty

Principle: Your personal data is your property.

Individuals should be able to own, control, and selectively monetize their personal data through provenance-documented instruments, instead of having that value captured entirely by data brokers and platforms.

Plank 7: Open research ownership

Principle: Researchers should benefit from the discoveries they make.

Scientists and researchers retain ownership stakes in discoveries they help create, including those funded by public money, so that when a breakthrough becomes a billion-dollar product, the people in the lab share in the upside.

Plank 8: Manufacturing expertise preservation

Principle: Automation should create owners, not just unemployment.

Document and recognize factory workers' accumulated process knowledge as an asset. When that expertise is used to automate their jobs, workers retain an ownership stake in the automated systems and their output.

Plank 9: Regulatory sandbox innovation

Principle: Innovation needs room to prove itself; consumers need protection while it does.

Support **regulated sandboxes** where new financial instruments like PBS can be tested under supervision before full-scale regulation, balancing innovation with consumer and investor protection.

Plank 10: Meritocratic education

Principle: The next generation needs to understand how to own their contributions.

Integrate financial literacy, intellectual property, and provenance documentation into K-12 and higher education so students learn not just how to create value, but how to **own** it.

Plank 11: Anti-monopoly in intangible markets

Principle: Open exchanges break monopoly pricing power.

PBS exchanges create transparent price discovery and competition in markets currently dominated by a few corporations. When independent creators can list their IP on open exchanges, information asymmetry and monopoly power weaken.

Plank 12: International leadership

Principle: If we don't build it, someone else will.

The U.S. should lead in setting global standards for intangible asset ownership infrastructure. If other jurisdictions define the rules first, American creators and workers will be subject to frameworks they didn't design.

Part III: Messaging framework (sanitized)

Core message

"If you create the value, you own the asset."

That's the bumper sticker. Everything else is an explanation of how we make that real.

Short pitches by audience

Workers Your employer can lay you off—but they can't erase your expertise. We want infrastructure that lets your skills exist as documented, tradeable assets, and that pays you when your work trains AI systems.

Farmers A handful of companies dominate the global seed market. A PBS-based seed genetics exchange gives independent breeders a way to reach you directly, increasing choice and pushing prices toward fair, competitive levels.

Artists and creators Copyright tells people not to steal your work. PBS tells the world what your work is worth—backed by real performance data—and lets you own tradeable shares in your own catalog.

Tech workers You built the AI, trained the models, and wrote the code. When that expertise is embedded into automated systems, you should own a piece of what those systems earn.

Entrepreneurs The intangible economy is tens of trillions of dollars and growing. PBS is the ownership infrastructure for that asset class. First movers will define the standards and capture the upside.

Legislators Your state can be the Delaware of the intangible economy—the jurisdiction that defines the legal infrastructure for 21st-century asset ownership. The conceptual framework and draft language exist; the question is who moves first.

Part IV: FAQ (public, not tactical)

"Isn't this just cryptocurrency / blockchain hype?"

PBS are **regulated securities**, not speculative tokens. Distributed ledgers are used as plumbing for provenance and auditability, but the core idea is simple: creators can finally own and trade the intangible assets they produce, with values anchored in real-world performance data, not hype.

"Is this socialism or forced redistribution?"

No. It's about **establishing property rights** where none currently exist. When a breeder creates a new seed variety or a developer creates a model architecture, that's their contribution. PBS creates markets and instruments so they can own and trade that value. That's closer to capitalism done properly than to redistribution.

"Won't this overregulate innovation?"

The model emphasizes **sandboxed experimentation** and market-based mechanisms. The real innovation killer is monopoly and lack of market access. PBS aims to increase competition and transparency, not to smother new ideas in red tape.

“How is this different from NFTs?”

NFTs showed that people want to own digital assets, but most were speculative and lacked verified provenance or performance. PBS values are tied to **measured outputs**—crop yields, streaming revenue, licensing income—validated by independent oracles. Ownership is backed by evidence, not vibes.

“Is this just a single-issue party?”

Ownership is not a single issue—it’s the foundation of every economy. Land, companies, ideas, data, and expertise all raise the same question: who owns what gets created? PBS and provenance-based ownership touch labor, agriculture, tech, education, trade, and more.